

How to Build Your First Course on NCYSA Learn

Hi Colin — welcome! You now have a course-designer login on the NCYSA Learn platform. This one-pager walks you through building and saving your first course. It takes about 15 minutes. You can't break anything, so feel free to explore.

1. Sign in

1. Go to the NCYSA Learn site: <https://ncysa-learn.onrender.com/>
2. Click **Sign in** (top right).
3. Enter your email: **DA@ncsoccer.org**, and the password Jeremy gives you.
4. Click **Sign in**. You'll land on your **Course Designer** page.

You're a course designer, so you'll see the course builder — not the staff dashboard or learner records. That's expected.

2. Create a course

1. Click **+ New course** (top right).
2. Fill in:
 - **Title** — e.g. "Sideline Management for Coaches"
 - **Tagline** — one short line describing it
 - **Description** — a sentence or two
 - **Badge** — a short label shown on the course card (e.g. "Coaching")
 - **Audience** — who the course is for. Pick one:
 - **Everyone** — shows to coaches and in staff training
 - **Coaches only**
 - **Referees only**
 - **Staff training** — shows only in the staff area
3. Click **Create course**. It appears in your list, ready for lessons.

3. Add lessons

Click **+ Add lesson** on your course, then pick a **Lesson type**. Lessons appear to learners in the order you add them, and each one unlocks only after the previous is finished.

Reading — a title plus your content. You can paste basic formatting.

Video — see the video section below.

Exam / quiz — a title, a **pass mark** (e.g. 80%), and questions. For each question, type the prompt, fill in the answer options, and click the circle next to the correct answer. Add as many questions as you like with **+ Add question**.

Click **Add lesson** to save each one. That's it — your course is saved as you go.

4. Adding a video (important)

The video field asks for a **link** to your video, not a file upload. Here's the easy way to get that link:

1. In your **WordPress dashboard**, find **Media** in the menu on the **left-hand side** — it's in the same area you'd use to get to **Events**.
2. Click **Add New** and upload your video file.
3. After it uploads, click the video and **copy its file URL** (WordPress shows a “Copy URL to clipboard” button, or a “File URL” field).
4. Back in NCYSA Learn, paste that link into the **Video URL (MP4)** field of your video lesson.
5. Set the **Duration (seconds)**. The “must-watch” time fills in automatically (a couple seconds less than the full length), so learners have to actually watch it — no skipping ahead.
6. Click **Add lesson**.

Heads up for later: to keep the WordPress media library tidy, we'll move to hosting course videos in a shared **Dropbox** folder instead. Jeremy will share that folder with you when it's ready — until then, WordPress is perfect.

5. You're done

Your course saves automatically as you add each piece — there's no separate “publish” button to worry about. Once it has at least one lesson, it's live for the audience you chose, and learners can enroll and take it. When someone finishes, they get a certificate and NCYSA is notified automatically.

Questions or stuck on anything? Just reach out to Jeremy.